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# EE/RPF

## For use from May/November 2027



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Student personal code:

# Extended essay - Reflection and progress form

***Student:*** *This form is to be completed by you and your supervisor during the progress and completion of the extended essay. It records your progress through the extended essay process and includes your reflective statement addressing your extended essay experience. You must undertake three formal reflection sessions with your supervisor: The first formal reflection session should focus on your initial ideas and how you plan to undertake your research; the interim reflection session takes place once a significant amount of your research has been completed, and the final session will be in the form of a viva voce, once you have completed and handed in your extended essay. This document acts as a record in supporting the authenticity of your work. Following the viva voce, you write a* ***reflective statement*** *of no more than 500 words., which must be included on the RPF.*

**The completion of this form is a mandatory requirement of the extended essay. It must be submitted together with the completed essay. The reflective statement will then be assessed under Criterion E. Students and supervisors should be aware that a mark of 0 will be awarded by the examiner for criterion E if the RPF is blank or the reflective statement is written in a language other than that of the accompanying essay.**

***Supervisor:*** *You must have three reflection sessions with each student, one early in the process, an interim meeting and then the final viva voce. Other check-in sessions are permitted but do not need to be recorded on this sheet. After each reflection session you must record the month that the reflection session took place, the student's year of DP study at that time and initial the form.*
***By submitting this student work for assessment, you are taking responsibility for its authenticity. No piece of student work should be uploaded/submitted to the e-Coursework system if its authenticity is in doubt.***

***First reflection session***

Month: DP year (1 or 2): Supervisor initials:

***Interim reflection session***

Month: DP year (1 or 2): Supervisor initials:

***Final reflection session – Viva voce***

Month: DP year (1 or 2): Supervisor initials:

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## Reflective statement

(No more than 500 words, written in the same language as the accompanying extended essay)

I had first wanted to write my EE in Economics and had decided on my topic. But I soon learned the major importance of being able to find appropriate resources; as I had difficulty finding what I needed, I decided to change my subject and topic to English B, which turned out to be a very good decision. I feel that I would not have achieved as much if I had stayed in Economics. I gained a new understanding of the developments in the women's liberation movement, and how these can be shown even in a film for children. It is surprising how current attitudes can affect the storyline of a children's movie.

I decided to focus mainly on analysing the two chosen movies and back myself up with other resources. It was one of the biggest challenges I encountered during the writing process, as it was not easy to find reliable secondary sources. My supervisor helped me a lot with that part. I was able to develop my research question better as the writing process went on, which also led to my needing different resources than in the beginning. I think if I had focused first on developing the research question more precisely at the start, I could have avoided that.

I also struggled with focusing on the analysis part, which took me a lot of time to fix and improve. With time, I knew what I was looking for and I definitely developed my analysis skills.

Looking back on the whole process, I realise now that it could have been much faster and easier if I had made a clear plan for the essay. That is something I will do next time when writing research. I needed to know where I was aiming to go with the investigation, rather than just writing, and finding the conclusion only at the end. During the process I also had to improve my self-management skills, which will also be useful in my future, especially considering self-study in the university, and report writing.

I think I was very successful with my work, as I achieved my goals, answered the research question, and enjoyed the process. I learned research skills which will be very important in my future at university. It was one of the worst parts of writing the Extended Essay, but also the most useful. Apart from that, I did not expect the writing process to be so easy for me; however, as I picked an interesting topic after the primary research and analysis, it was easier than I expected.  I learned that if I just start something, it gets easier along the way as I gain some experience.  Looking at the progress between my first draft and the final version I also saw improvement in my general writing and analysis skills, which was a surprise.

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